CREDITBUDDY PARTNERS PRIVATE LIMITED

CIN: U62090OR2026PTC[●●●●●●] | Registered: Bhubaneswar, Odisha

PRIVACY POLICY

Governing Collection, Use, Storage & Protection of Personal Data

Version 1.0 | Effective: April 1, 2026

SCOPE OF THIS POLICY

CreditBuddy Partners Private Limited ('CreditBuddy') is committed to protecting the privacy and security of your personal data. This Privacy Policy explains how we collect, use, share, store, and protect your personal information in compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (DPDPA), the Information Technology Act 2000, the SPDI Rules 2011, and RBI Digital Lending Guidelines 2022.

This Policy applies to all users of the CreditBuddy platform across the BORROW, LEARN, and EARN verticals.

1. Who We Are & Our Role

CreditBuddy Partners Private Limited is a SaaS technology intermediary and Lending Service Provider (LSP) incorporated under the Companies Act 2013 in Odisha, India (NIC Codes: 62090, 63120). Our registered office is in Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

In the context of data protection law:

- For data collected directly on the Platform: CreditBuddy is the Data Fiduciary (Data Controller) under the DPDPA 2023.
- For data transmitted to NBFC/Bank Partners for loan processing: CreditBuddy acts as a Data Processor on behalf of the NBFC/Bank Partner (the Data Fiduciary for lending purposes).
- For data transmitted to EdTech partners or employer partners: the applicable partner becomes the Data Fiduciary for that data interaction.

2. Personal Data We Collect

2.1 Identity & KYC Data

- Full legal name, date of birth, gender, nationality
- PAN card, Aadhaar number (last 4 digits for display; full number processed via UIDAI-authorised channels only), Voter ID, Passport, or other identity documents
- Student ID, university/college enrollment data (for age and student verification)

2.2 Contact & Location Data

- Mobile number, email address, residential and permanent address (with PIN code)
- Geolocation data (coarse and precise, with your consent) — used for fraud prevention and partner service matching

2.3 Financial & Credit Data

- Bank account details (IFSC, account number) — transmitted to NBFC partners for loan disbursement only
- Credit bureau reports obtained from credit information companies (CIBIL, Experian, CRIF, Equifax) with your explicit consent
- Account Aggregator (AA) data obtained through NBFC partners with your consent under the AA framework (NBFC-AA)
- Income proof documents: salary slips, ITR, bank statements — transmitted to NBFC partners for credit assessment

2.4 Platform Usage & Device Data

- Device identifiers (IMEI, device ID, MAC address), operating system, app version
- IP address, browser type, session data, clickstream data
- App usage patterns, feature interactions, session duration
- Communication preferences and notification interaction history

2.5 Employment & Educational Data (EARN & LEARN Verticals)

- Resume, skills, educational qualifications, certifications
- Course enrollment and progress data
- Gig work history and employer feedback (within the EARN Vertical)

3. Purposes of Data Processing

Purpose	Data Used	Legal Basis
User registration & KYC verification	Identity, contact, Aadhaar data	Statutory obligation (RBI KYC); Consent
Credit application processing (BORROW)	Financial, identity, bureau data	Consent; Contract performance
Transmission to NBFC/Bank Partner	Financial, identity, KYC data	Consent; Contract performance
Course discovery & enrolment (LEARN)	Educational, contact data	Consent; Contract performance
Gig matching (EARN)	Skills, resume, contact data	Consent; Contract performance
Fraud detection & risk management	Device, location, behavioural data	Legitimate interest; Regulatory obligation
Platform improvement & analytics	Anonymised usage data	Legitimate interest
Regulatory reporting (RBI, UIDAI, MCA)	As required by regulator	Statutory obligation
Customer support & grievance redressal	Account, communication data	Contract; Legitimate interest
Marketing & personalised recommendations	Usage, preference data	Consent (separate, revocable)

4. Consent Framework

4.1 CreditBuddy collects consent separately for each purpose listed in Section 3. Consent for one purpose does not imply consent for another.

4.2 Consent is collected in plain language at the point of collection — no bundled or buried consent in lengthy T&Cs.

4.3 You have the right to withdraw consent at any time through the Platform's settings. Withdrawal of consent will not affect any processing already carried out before withdrawal.

4.4 Where data is required for a statutory purpose (e.g., KYC), we are required to collect it regardless of consent. We will clearly indicate this at the point of collection.

4.5 Marketing consent is entirely optional and will not affect your ability to access core platform services.

5. Data Sharing

5.1 Sharing with Partner Institutions

When you apply for a loan, enrol in a course, or apply for a gig, only the data specifically required for that transaction is shared with the relevant partner. Partner institutions are bound by data processing agreements that require them to comply with DPDPA 2023 and applicable data protection obligations.

5.2 Sharing with Technology Vendors

CreditBuddy engages technology vendors for cloud hosting, KYC verification, analytics, and communication services. All vendors are contractually bound to process data only on CreditBuddy's instructions, in India (data localisation), and to maintain appropriate security standards.

5.3 Regulatory Disclosure

CreditBuddy will disclose personal data to law enforcement agencies, regulatory bodies (RBI, UIDAI, NPCI, SEBI as applicable), or courts when required by a lawful order. CreditBuddy will not voluntarily disclose data beyond the minimum required by such orders.

5.4 We Do NOT Sell Your Data

> **✓ COMMITMENT — No Sale of Personal Data**
> CreditBuddy does not sell, rent, or trade your personal data to any third party for commercial purposes. Data is shared only as described in this Policy.

6. Data Localisation & Storage

- All personal data collected by CreditBuddy is stored on servers located within India, in compliance with RBI data localisation norms.
- Cloud infrastructure, even where provided by international vendors, is configured to store data only in India-based data centres.
- Data retention periods are as follows:
  - KYC and identity data: 5 years from the date of last transaction or account closure, whichever is later (as per RBI KYC Master Directions)
  - Loan application data: 8 years from date of last loan transaction (as per PMLA requirements)
  - Usage and device data: 2 years from collection
  - Marketing preference data: Until withdrawal of consent
- Data is securely deleted or anonymised at the end of the retention period.

7. Your Rights Under DPDPA 2023

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, you have the following rights as a Data Principal:

Right to Access	Request a summary of the personal data we hold about you and how it is being processed.
Right to Correction	Request correction of inaccurate or incomplete personal data.
Right to Erasure	Request deletion of your personal data where processing is no longer necessary, subject to statutory retention obligations.
Right to Grievance Redressal	Lodge a complaint with our Grievance Officer (grievance@creditbuddy.in) within the timelines specified in Section 9.
Right to Nominate	Nominate a person to exercise your rights in the event of your death or incapacity.
Right to Withdraw Consent	Withdraw consent for any purpose at any time through Platform settings. Withdrawal is prospective and does not affect lawful processing prior to withdrawal.

8. Security Measures

- Encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest (AES-256) for all sensitive personal data
- Role-based access controls — employees access data only to the extent required for their specific function
- Periodic security assessments, penetration testing, and vulnerability scanning
- Vendor security assessments before onboarding any data processor
- Incident response procedures — data breaches reported to the Data Protection Board (once constituted under DPDPA) and to affected users within 72 hours of discovery

9. Grievance Officer — Data Privacy

Name	[Founder Director Name]
Designation	Data Protection Officer / Grievance Officer
Email	privacy@creditbuddy.in
Address	CreditBuddy Partners Private Limited, [Registered Office], Bhubaneswar, Odisha
Response	Acknowledgement within 48 hours; Resolution within 30 days

If your grievance is not resolved to your satisfaction within 30 days, you may approach the Data Protection Board of India (once constituted under DPDPA 2023) or the RBI Ombudsman for Digital Lending at cms.rbi.org.in.

10. Cookies & Tracking

The CreditBuddy app and website use cookies and similar tracking technologies for session management, analytics, and personalisation. You may control cookie preferences through your browser or device settings. Disabling certain cookies may affect Platform functionality.

11. Changes to this Policy

CreditBuddy may update this Privacy Policy to reflect changes in law, technology, or platform features. Material changes will be communicated to you via in-app notification or email at least 7 days before the change takes effect. Your continued use of the Platform after the effective date constitutes acceptance of the revised Policy.